

HC Services — People Code

Section 9: Grievance & Appeals Policy

Section 9.0: Document Control

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1.3	1 January 2025	—	Current version.

Section 9.1: Policy Scope

This policy covers any concern, problem, or complaint an employee wishes to raise about their employment, and every appeal against a decision taken under this Code.

Section 9.2: Raising a Grievance or Appeal

9.2.1 Informal Stage

An employee is encouraged to raise the matter with their line manager first. Where the grievance concerns the line manager, it may be raised directly with People & Culture.

9.2.2 Formal Stage

A formal grievance is submitted in writing to People & Culture. A hearing is held within **10 working days** of receipt, and a written outcome issued within a further **5 working days**.

9.2.3 Appeals

Any decision under HC-PC-003 (probation), HC-PC-005 (a rejected expense claim), HC-PC-006 (a disciplinary sanction), or HC-PC-008 (a capability outcome) may be appealed within **10 working days** of the written outcome. An appeal is heard by a manager who was not involved in the original decision.

Raising a grievance does not pause a probationary period (HC-PC-003 §3.7), and does not suspend a disciplinary sanction unless People & Culture directs otherwise.

Section 9.3: Protection from Detriment

No employee will be subjected to detriment for raising a grievance in good faith. Retaliation against an employee who has raised a grievance is gross misconduct under HC-PC-006 §6.4.

For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at people@hcservices.ae or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.